



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

MAR 2018

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for April is

March 16

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

March



SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:15 am Education and Fellowship.

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in March

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.				1 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a God's Renewed Creation: Call to Hope and Action 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	2 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA 7p Movie Night	3 11:01a Auction (doors open 10a) 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
4 Communion 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Confirmation Classes 7p SAA	5 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy & Cub Scouts 6:30p Finance 6:30p God's Renewed Creation	6 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	7 10a Staff Meeting 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	8 International Women's Day 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a God's Renewed Creation 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Communications	9 Pinewood Derby (PENDING) 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	10 Pinewood Derby (PENDING) 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
11 Daylight Saving Time Begins 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 2p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	12 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 5:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p God's Renewed Creation	13 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council 6:30p Nokomis Neighborhood Group	14 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir	15 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a God's Renewed Creation 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	16 Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	17 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 5p Pizza Party & Movie Night
18 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Confirmation Classes 7p SAA	19 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy & Cub Scouts 6:30p God's Renewed Creation	20 Spring Begins Piano Tune 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers) 6:30p Worship Committee	21 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir	22 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a God's Renewed Creation 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	23 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	24 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
25 Palm Sunday 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Confirmation Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	26 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p God's Renewed Creation	27 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	28 5p Methodicals 5:30p Dinner and Program 6:45p Chancel Choir	29 Maundy Thursday 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a God's Renewed Creation 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Maundy Thursday Seder & Service	30 Good Friday 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Tenebrae	31 8:45a Brighter Minds Music

Worship in March

Lent occupies the entire month of March, so we are continuing our theme of looking for God in the wilderness, utilizing ideas from a book called *Gifts of the Dark Wood*. And, since Easter is on April 1, the last week of March is Holy Week. See more information elsewhere in the newsletter about the Seder we'll be holding on Maundy Thursday and the Good Friday Tenebrae service. And, of course, Easter services will be at 7:00 a.m., 9:00 a.m. and 11:00 a.m. on April 1. See you in worship!

4th **"Finding Ourselves in the Dark Wood"**

Psalms 88:1-3, 9b-14, 18

Communion, Lee Krokum preaches

11th **"Gift of Temptation"**

Matthew 4:1-11

18th **"Gift of Getting Lost"**

I Samuel 3:1-14

25th **"Gift of Failure"**

Mark 11:1-11

Palm Sunday

Holy Week

March 29: Maundy Thursday 6:00pm Christian Seder followed by Communion

March 30: Good Friday 7:00pm Tenebrae Service

April 1: Easter Sunday Services at 7:00, 9:00, 11:00

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- April 1 – Easter Sunday
- May 20 – One Service Sunday – Children's Musical
- May 27 – One Service Sunday – Memorial Day Weekend
- June 3 – One Service Sunday – Graduation Sunday
- June 10 – Summer outdoor services begin. Blessing of bikes and bike helmets at both services, potluck picnic following the second service.
- June 18-22 – Music and Drama Camp
- June 20-22 – Vacation Bible School

Time Change

It's time to spring ahead and gain some sunlight in our mornings. Set your clocks forward one hour before coming to worship on Sunday, March 11.



**WEDNESDAYS at
MINNEHAHA UMC**

Join us for supper from 5:30-6:30
in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20
PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD
& RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!

Programming for Kids:
From 6:15-7pm each week, elementary students will
meet to prepare for Children's Sunday in room 208,
preschoolers & kindergartners will have activity time
in room 202 & 204.
The Minnehaha Adult Choir Rehearses
at 6:45pm in room 310

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

March 16

Youth Ministries

Here is a look forward at the next month for our Youth ministries program. We have a lot of activities coming up for our Youth and volunteers with opportunities to Seek, Serve, and to Celebrate! All the things we do best here at Minnehaha.

February 24th – MinneHarvest: Youth and families are getting together to volunteer with MinneHarvest. One out of every six Minnesotans are food insecure and our Youth have decided they wanted to help feed those in need. There is two separate times that we could use help, come early and help unload the food truck at 7am, or come later at 9am to help with food distribution and clean up.

February 25th – Confirmation Night: 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be discussing Making Good Decisions.

March 3rd – Church Auction: Youth are serving Breakfast and Lunch again this year! We will be becoming authentic baristas in the kitchen, serving all kinds of coffee treats, as well as serving lunch from 10am-2pm. Breakfast is from 10-12, and lunch 12-2. Even if you can only come for a little while, please come and join us!

March 4th – Confirmation Night: 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be finishing the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be discussing Grace & Sin / Heaven & Hell.

March 10th – Pinewood Derby fundraiser for Camps: Youth are serving Breakfast and Lunch this year for the Boy Scouts Pinewood Derby. We will be serving all kinds of coffee and donuts from 10am-2pm, and pizza and hotdogs for lunch from 12-2. The Youth (and Parents) are also encouraged to make their own Derby car to race each other after the scouts are finished. Please contact Leilani Thompson or Travis Beck for a car set if you are interested.

March 11th – Youth Night: 3:00-6:00pm. Youth will be playing Broomball at McRae park.
Friends are always welcome to join us! And we can still use a extra chaperone or two!

March 18th – Confirmation Night: 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the Easter Sunrise worship service. The older class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Choir room and will be discussing Prayer.

March 25th – Confirmation Night: 4:00-5:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the Easter Sunrise worship service. The older class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Choir room and will be discussing Heaven and Hell.

March 31st – Sunrise Service Rehearsal and Pizza dinner: 4:00-6:00pm. Youth are getting together for our final rehearsal for the Easter Sunrise service. If your youth is participating in the Sunrise service PLEASE have them come to the rehearsal. Rehearsal will be a hour and then we will have a pizza dinner and play some games. There is no cost for the pizza.

In case Youth Camps are not on your calendar yet here our the dates, if you want more info talk to Lani Thompson.

- Minnehaha Adventure Camp: July 15-17 (finished grades 5th & 6th this spring) at Koronis Retreat Center
- Minnehaha Wilderness Camp: July 29-Aug 3rd (finished grades 7th-12th this spring) at Star Lake Campgrounds

Leilani Thompson, *Director of Youth Ministries*

Children's Ministries

The desert of the North American southwest is an amazing place. Months and months go by without rain, and plants and animals adapt and survive and even thrive. I write from Arizona, where it rained all day yesterday, and so I was greeted this morning with the amazing smell of the desert after the rain. This very distinct smell comes from the creosote bush. It's almost as if the plants come alive with the rain. Their leaves absorb the moisture, releasing oils that make this smell of desert rain. The creosote bush is incredible, more drought tolerant than any plant in North America. In the Mojave Desert, there's a cluster (the plants clone and often end up in a ring pattern) that's thought to be over 11,000 years old. They survive in the desert where other plants would never try, facing the southeast to greet the morning sun, and providing shelter and food for desert creatures.

I'm not going for a hike in the desert wilderness today, I'm drinking coffee and getting some work done. But, the sounds of the birds singing, the smell of the creosote, the barks of trees wet and content from the rain, these all seem fitting senses to be experiencing as we start this Lenten season. Knowing that I am surrounded by plants and animals who survive and thrive in wilderness, who have adapted to get through incredible droughts, who greet the morning sun, who've evolved as part of an ecosystem that protects and nurtures each other: this gives me hope - for all of creation.

Wilderness - literal and figurative - is part of all of our lives, our kids' lives, too. Throughout Lent, Pastor Becky is exploring how this wilderness can be a place for us to encounter God, build community, find peace, and find hope. Throughout Lent, we can explore with our families where it is that we see God in this world, where it is that we can be God's hand in this world, where it is that we can build community, make peace, and inspire hope. And, like the desert after a rain, we can be transformed by the water of life.

At Minnehaha in March, our regular weekly program continues. Join us on Sunday mornings for worship and faith formation, on Wednesday evenings for dinner and programming, and Thursday mornings for our Minnehaha Playgroup for children five and under and their caregivers. The last week of March is Holy Week. Elsewhere in this newsletter, you will find more details about the week. It begins with Palm Sunday, but we also have special services on Maundy Thursday, and Good Friday before celebrating Easter (on April Fools' Day this year!) All of



*Who's ready for a night out?
Children have a fun night at church.
Parents have a relaxing night out together.
Funds go to support children & youth programs.*

the Minnehaha Children's Council's
**Spring Child Care at Minnehaha
& Parents' Night Out**

When: Saturday, 10th April from 5-8pm
Where: Child Care Provided at Minnehaha UMC

Cost:
\$25-1 child
\$35-2 children
\$40-3 children
For children up to 11 years of age

PLEASE RSVP BY March 30th
Online Registration Available – Link at
www.minnehaha.org
or by calling Jenia at 612.721.6231

these services are great things to attend with families - we participate in rituals and hear the story of Easter, and can celebrate as a community the incredible power of love in transforming the world. We hope you'll join us.

Also, we're in full speed ahead mode for summer camps. Information is available in the narthex and online at www.minnehaha.org. Register today!

And, as always, please let me know if you have any questions or concerns (or want to hear more about how awesome the desert is in the spring!).

Looking forward to
welcoming spring
with you,

Jenia Strom
*Director of Children &
Family Ministries*



Minnehaha Playgroup
For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by
Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Children's Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

MINNEHAHA CAMPS FOR CHILDREN AND YOUTH

At Minnehaha

Vacation Bible School

Ages: 3 – 10 years olds (as of June 1, 2018)

What: At Rolling River Rampage, kids will participate in a wide variety of activities (science, crafts, recreation, music, and more) to help remind them that through all life's adventures: God is with us!

When: Wednesday, June 20th-Friday June 22nd, 9-11:30am

Cost: \$25/child \$40/family

Extended care is available. Register at Minnehaha UMC or at www.minnehaha.org.

Questions? Talk with Jenia Strom.

Music & Drama Camp

Ages: 8-14 years olds (as of June 1, 2018)

What: This year, we'll be exploring *Stories of Extraordinary People* while working together on all aspects of an original musical production.

When: Monday, June 18th-Friday, June 22nd, 9am-3pm

Cost: \$100/person

This camp culminates in an evening performance on Friday, June 22nd.

Register at Minnehaha UMC or at www.minnehaha.org. Questions? Talk with Jenia Strom.

Away From Minnehaha

Trailblazers Camp 1 at Camp Koronis

Ages: 8-12 years olds (as of June 1, 2018)

What: Campers will get an opportunity to try out archery, boating, swimming, and more, while staying at cabins on the shore of Lake Koronis. This camp is part of Camp Minnesota, the camping ministries of the Minnesota Annual Conference.

When: July 8-11th

Cost: \$265

If you are interested in an overnight camp, and this timing doesn't work for you, there are countless more opportunities through Camp Minnesota. Register ASAP for this camp at www.campminnesota.org. Questions? Talk with Jenia Strom.

Minnehaha Adventure Camp

Ages: Youth who are entering 6th and 7th grades

When: July 15th-17th

Where: Koronis Retreat Center, Paynesville, MN

Cost: \$155

Register at Minnehaha UMC. Questions? Talk with Leilani Thompson.

Minnehaha Wilderness Camp

For who: Youth who are entering 8th through 12th grade

When: July 29th-August 3rd

Where: Star Lake Campgrounds, Pequot Lakes, MN

Cost: \$200

Register at Minnehaha UMC. Questions? Talk with Leilani Thompson.

Adult Class Continues

Did you know that the United Methodist Church has official beliefs about the environment and how we interact with God's Creation? This Lenten season, we'll take a closer look at what those beliefs are in a 6-week class that looks closely at the Pastoral Letter from the Council of Bishops entitled God's Renewed Creation: Call to Hope and Action. The class is held on both Monday evenings from 6:30-8, until March 26 and Thursday mornings from 10-11:30, until March 29. There is no need to do any reading beforehand, just come to class ready to engage with each other around the topic.

Readers Needed for Good Friday

For Good Friday this year (March 30), we will be utilizing 14 readings during the worship service. Each reading comes from the Gospel According to Mark and each reader extinguishes a candle after the reading. If you would like to be one of the readers, please talk to Becky and she'll find a reading for you. Thanks!

Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., there is a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of some kind around current events in the world or in the church. In March we will be gathering on March 8.

Easter Services

Join us for Easter Sunday on April 1. We'll start out with a sunrise service at 7:00 a.m. in the sanctuary. The youth will be leading this worship, and have a great theme planned. The Men's Group will serve breakfast from 8-9, and there is an Easter egg hunt for children from 10-11. At 9:00 is a more traditional service with choir and organ (and the singing of the Hallelujah Chorus), and the 11:00 service features band and vocals. We hope to see you on Easter morning!

Holy Week at Minnehaha



Palm Sunday – March 25th

Worship at 9 and 11am – Children are invited to join in the Palm Processional, and the Cherub Choir will be singing at both services

Maundy Thursday – March 29th

Join for **dinner** and an adaptation of the **Jewish Seder Meal at 6pm**, followed by a **communion service commemorating the Last Supper** in the Sanctuary.

Good Friday – March 30th

The sanctuary will be opened for contemplation and **Stations of the Cross** from 9am-5pm, utilizing the artwork of DeGrazia

Tenebrae Service at 7pm. Will include readings, music, silence, and the extinguishing of lights.

Easter Sunday – April 1st

Sunrise Service at 7am; Breakfast served from 8-9am; Worship with organ, choir, Hallelujah Chorus & Children's Choir at 9am; Easter Egg Hunt & Easter Crafts from 10-11am; Worship with band & Children's Choir at 11am



United Methodist Women

We will be serving dinner at Simpson Shelter on Monday, Feb. 27 and Monday March 27. We always need folks to help. The meals will be prepared the day before on Sunday afternoon and there will be a car leaving Minnehaha UMC at 5:30 to go to Simpson...or you can meet us there. Please let Maureen Trepp at 612-724-7620 know if you are planning on helping.

Food Ministries

MUMC supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us this month on March 9 for a time of renewal.





Lenten Personal Dignity Drive to benefit the Minnehaha Food Shelf

*Consider bringing the following items with you to worship,
or dropping them off at Minnehaha any time throughout the season.*

February 18th-24th: Toothpaste and Toothbrushes
 February 25th-March 3rd: Toilet Paper
 March 4th-10th: Soap – Bar Soap, Shampoo, and Conditioner
 March 11th-17th: Deoderant, Razors, and Shaving Cream
 March 18th-24th: Feminine Hygiene Products & Newborn-Sized Diapers
 Palm Sunday, March 25th: Food Donations

Minnehaha UMC Lent 2018 Gifts of the Dark Wood

First Friday Films

Do you find yourself shouting advice to characters during a movie? Nudging your neighbor with an elbow during critical scenes? Wishing you had someone to talk to about the movie you just watched? Then you are in luck! Come to the church on the first Friday of the month at 7:00 and settle in to watch a movie with fellow Minnehaha-ians. Bring your own beverage and snacks, and feel free to bring a friend as well. After the credits roll, you'll have an opportunity to share your "aha" moments, the things you liked or disliked, or anything else the movie prompted in you.

Nine people showed up to watch "Trade" last month, and they had a great conversation afterwards about human trafficking and the role the church has taken in trying to put an end to it. This month, we'll watch "Lars and the Real Girl," about a painfully shy young man and the community that bands together to help him heal, even though they don't necessarily understand him or his actions. We look forward to seeing you on Friday, March 2 at 7:00 in Room 208.

Minnehaha Talent Show & Dessert Auction

Do you play an instrument? Sing melodiously? Twirl a baton? Tap dance like Gene Kelly? We have a chance for you to show off your special talent this spring! In the near future (date yet to be confirmed), we'll be hosting our own Talent Show with our famous Dessert Auction.

If you have a talent you would like to share with your friends and family of Minnehaha, then please see Julia Cook or Annette Meier to sign-up. We'll also be doing our Dessert Auction that we've done in the past. We'll have fancy desserts so you and your tablemates will pool your funds to outbid another table for a delicious and luxurious dessert.

This delightful evening is a fundraiser to support Minnehaha's ministries and programs - here on 37th Avenue and beyond. Watch for the new date of this fun event - we're looking forward to having you all join us!

Planning Meeting for LGBTQ in the UMC

2018 could turn out to be a crucial year for the Reconciling Movement as the Commission on a Way Forward makes a recommendation to the UMC Bishops in anticipation of a special General Conference to be held February of 2019 in St. Louis.

Everyone is welcome to join us for our annual gathering to be held this year at Centennial UMC in Roseville on Saturday March 10th starting at 11:30. After the potluck meal, we will have a presentation from Dave Nuckols who is has been part of the Commission. Hear first hand his assessment of the work of the commission and what is the future of the LGBTQ debate in the United Methodist Church.

MINNEHAHA LOCAL PIZZERIA POTLUCK & GAME NIGHT

Hosted by Todd & Tracy Gulliver

For MUMC adults of all ages

**When: Saturday, March 17,
from 5-9pm**

**Where: Becketwood's Windsor Room
(4300 W. River Pkwy, Mpls)**



Join us for food, fun and conversation at a pizza party potluck.
Bring your favorite pizza (from a neighborhood restaurant, the grocery store, or one of your own creations), a side dish and/or a dessert to share. Sample the pizzas and vote for your favorites. We hope you can join us!

To RSVP, email Tracy Gulliver at tracygulliver@gmail.com or call 612-999-9027

Auction

Now's the time to be looking for ***gently-used*** items in your household that you no longer need, but that could help us raise some money at the Auction! If you have large items, please contact Eric Pederson or Annette Meier and they'll arrange pick-up for you. You can find them most Sunday mornings between services, or can you email/text/call them at : Eric Pederson (952) 250-7444 or ricpederson50@yahoo.com / Annette Meier (612) 597-1778 or sal-meier@Hotmail.com. We'll be arranging pick-ups after the musical ("The Rockin' Tale of Snow White") mid-February.

Also - please pick up some flyers and distribute/post them at the local businesses in your neighborhood - talk-up this event with your friends and neighbors and plan on joining us for the fun on Sat., March 3rd. This is an all-church event and that we means we need all of you to help us with this great event!

Holy Week Services

Holy Week is observed during the last week of Lent, between Palm Sunday (March 25) and Easter Sunday (April 1). It is traditionally a time to remember Jesus' entry into Jerusalem, his last supper with the disciples, and his arrest, trial and death.

This year, we'll be offering a Maundy Thursday Seder meal in the Fellowship Hall beginning at 6:00 on March 29. We'll be following an adaptation of a Jewish Seder meal, including dinner, and then concluding with a communion service commemorating the Last Supper in the sanctuary. We should be done by 7:30.

We will also have a Good Friday service on March 30. Service. It will also start at 7:00 and will include 14 readings from the gospel of Mark about the events leading up to Jesus' death. It also includes music, silence, and the extinguishing of lights.

In addition, the sanctuary will be open on Good Friday between 9:00 and 5:00 for anyone who would like to engage in some silent contemplation. There is a centuries-old tradition of observing Stations of the Cross with words or artwork signifying important stops on Jesus' journey to the cross. Utilizing artwork by DeGrazia, we will have stations set up in the sanctuary.

Our Easter Garden

The Sanctuary will be decorated with flowering spring plants Easter morning. To contribute, please complete this form and bring/mail it to the church office or place it in an offering, with your payment, by March 18.

Given By: _____

Phone: _____

Suggested donation \$20. You may give more if you wish.

Given in:

☐ Memory of ☐ Celebration of ☐ Honor of ☐ _____
other

(please print)



(Plants may be taken home after the **11:00** Easter service or during the following week.)

Join with other Minnehaha folk concerned about gun violence in our country, & attend the:

**MINNESOTA
MARCH FOR OUR LIVES
SATURDAY, MARCH 24TH
10AM, AT THE
MINNESOTA STATE CAPITOL**

We'll be organizing group transportation as we get closer to the event.

If you are interested, please contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org or 612.721.6231



Replacing

I am about to embark on a DIY project. It makes Martha nervous every time I say, “wait, I bet we could do that ourselves!” But this time she is going to be on a weekend retreat, and the project only involves my home office, so she seems more calm than usual. The carpet in my office needs to be replaced. I think there is a perfectly good hardwood floor underneath, so I’m going to tear it out myself and see what I find. And, the walls could use a coat of paint, so it makes most sense to paint first, then rip up carpet, then see what I need to do to the floor. You begin to understand why Martha gets nervous Of course, this means that everything in my office needs to not be in my office. The furniture, books in the bookcase, stuff lying around on the floor, etc. And, it has to all go someplace it can sit for a few days, just in case the floor needs more work than my original peak under the corner of the carpet indicated. This has been my hesitation in doing this project all along. I can’t just get rid of old carpet, something has to go in its place. I either need to install new carpet, or I need to re-finish the floor underneath the carpet. And, there is a fair bit of chaos in the meantime. It is sort of like Lent. If I’m going to give something up, then it requires rearranging things. My spiritual life needs to be rearranged, some bookcases moved, some piles sorted through, in order to get at the thing that I’m going to give up. And then, I need to replace it with something. It’s kind of pointless to just give up chocolate. Why am I doing that? Just because it’s Lent? How about if I give up chocolate, and then every time I crave chocolate, I put a quarter aside and at the end of Lent, donate the money to an organization that works to create fair trade chocolate? After Lent, I’ll go back to eating chocolate, but I’ll be more aware of the chocolate I eat, and more likely to only purchase fair trade chocolate. Sort of like after the DIY project I’ll get my office back, but the walls will be a different color, and I might very well have a wood floor instead of carpeting, which will require other adaptations. I might need an area rug to absorb the sound for when I practice my clarinet. I might need to put little felt feet on my chair so it doesn’t scratch the floor. Or shore up one end of the bookcase because the floor is slightly uneven. Hopefully it won’t take all of Lent to do it, but some spiritual practices do need all of Lent, or even more time than that, to get to their intended purpose. My office project is slated for this weekend – between when I write this and when you read it – so you can check with me and see how it went, and whether my office furniture is still all piled up in the living room. And, you can tell me what you are doing for Lent – both what you are giving up and what you are replacing it with.

In joy,
Becky





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3/18



AUCTION

Saturday, March 3



Coffee & Doughnuts:

10 AM – 12 Noon

Auction Preview:

10 AM

AUCTION STARTS:

11:01 AM

Lunch Served:

12 Noon – 1:30 PM

Note: Delivery available. Starting at \$25.
All pieces moved day of sale. Storage fee
for anything left at church past Saturday.

**Cabinets, collectibles, housewares, furniture, antiques,
gift certificates, food, crafts, electronics, kids' stuff,
toys, books and who knows what else!**

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

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